

The one story you read that matters



FCT Impact in 2025

STRENGTHENS COMMUNITY WELLBEING IN THE FCT

In 2025, Life Helpers Initiative (LHI) FCT Office strengthened community well being through health, education, gender, and environmental initiatives. Over 38 advocacy engagements with key ministries expanded partnerships and visibility. School Health Clubs and spelling competitions

improved literacy and hygiene awareness, while GBV podcasts and dialogues promoted protection and inclusion. Traditional leadership engagement and regular monitoring strengthened trust and laid the foundation for sustainable impact across the FCT.

Strengthening Resilience, Restoring Dignity, Transforming Lives

Life Helpers Initiative is a humanitarian organization that operates across eleven states in Nigeria, supporting vulnerable populations impacted by poverty, displacement, conflict, and climate-related hardships. By employing people-centered, community-driven strategies, the organization delivers integrated programs in health, education, livelihood, agriculture, and gender equity. These initiatives are designed to address urgent needs while simultaneously building longterm resilience and pathways toward self-reliance.

Central to this work is deep collaboration with communities, government bodies, civil society, and development partners. Through these partnerships, Life Helpers Initiative ensures its programs are holistic, responsive, and impactful restoring dignity, expanding opportunity, and transforming lives across diverse and challenging contexts.



Opening Doors to Learning

In 2025, Life Helpers Initiative (LHI) improved access to education for out of school and displaced children in Goronyo IDP Camp and other communities across Sokoto State.



Hope Restored Through Care

In Shagari Local Government Area of Sokoto State, a young mother's life was transformed through timely and compassionate intervention. As her twin babies fell seriously ill, she



Azima's Journey from Child Bride

Azima Bello's childhood was marked by hardship hunger, loss, and early marriage forced on her at age fifteen. Feeling broken and voiceless, she returned home with little hope for her future.

OPENING DOORS TO LEARNING FOR DISPLACED AND OUT OF SCHOOL CHILDREN IN SOKOTO STATE



In 2025, Life Helpers Initiative strengthened access to education for out of school and displaced children across Sokoto State, with focused support in Goronyo IDP Camp and surrounding communities. Through the establishment and support of Non Formal Learning Centres, children who had missed years of schooling were given a second chance to learn in safe and supportive environments. More than one thousand children gained foundational literacy, numeracy, and essential life skills that prepared them for continued learning. With the support of trained facilitators, community structures, and government partners, many learners successfully transitioned into formal Junior Secondary Schools. Education in emergency interventions also helped protect children from learning disruption and strengthened continuity during periods of displacement and instability. By working closely with communities and education authorities, Life Helpers Initiative continues to promote inclusive education, child protection, and long term learning opportunities. These efforts are helping children rebuild confidence, remain in school, and move toward brighter futures despite challenging circumstances.

TOUCHING LIVES THROUGH AGRICULTURE



For over 21 years, Life Helpers Initiative has brought hope to communities across Nigeria. In partnership with the World Food Programme and FCDO, LHI has launched the Resilience Building and Smallholder Farmers Support Project in Sokoto and Katsina States. In Wamakko LGA, the newly opened Noma Tushen Aziki Farmers Service Hub now offers modern farming

support, storage facilities, job opportunities and a fully solar-powered service center. The hub includes a rental hall, charging points and an LHI office providing continuous assistance to farmers. This project marks a major step in strengthening livelihoods and boosting agricultural development in Northwest Nigeria.



For families like Aisha's in a flood-prone Sokoto village, past disasters have been marked by waiting and desperation. "Help would come late, or not at all," she remembers, describing how confusion and poor coordination left her and her children without shelter or supplies for days. This uncertainty is what a renewed partnership between Life Helpers Initiative and Sokoto's government aims to end. During a recent high-level meeting, leaders from the State Emergency Management Agency and the Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs pledged to strengthen coordination, ensuring that aid—especially vital Non-Food Items—reaches the most

THE MEETING THAT CHANGED THE RESPONSE

vulnerable quickly and with dignity. At the heart of the discussion was a commitment to relaunch and improve the state's disaster response system. Mallam Mustapha, speaking for SEMA, emphasized the need for transparent communication and regular stakeholder meetings to keep everyone aligned. "When we work as one, we save more lives," he stated, capturing the shared vision of a faster, more reliable humanitarian response. This unified approach promises to replace delayed, fragmented aid with a clear, community-focused delivery system.

For Aisha and countless others living on Sokoto's climate frontline, this renewed collaboration is more than a policy update—it's a promise of security and hope. As these partners transform dialogue into action, they are building a tangible safety net designed to ensure that no family is left behind when the next disaster strikes.



FROM EARLY MARRIAGE TO A FUTURE STITCHED WITH HOPE

Azima Bello's childhood in Zamfara was defined by profound loss and relentless struggle. Growing up without her mother and facing constant hunger, her young life was shadowed by fear and instability. Despite the best efforts of a caring aunt, poverty dictated their reality, culminating in Azima being forced into marriage at the age of fifteen. Thrust into adulthood while still a child, she endured a painful and silencing experience that left her broken and devoid of hope when she eventually returned to her family home. A transformative shift began when Life Helpers Initiative, through the UNICEF Early Child Marriage Project, created a safe space within her community. This program offered more than just information; it provided a supportive environment where Azima, alongside other girls with similar experiences, could begin to heal. In this space of trust and understanding, she slowly found the courage to express herself again, rediscovering a voice that had been silenced by trauma and societal pressure.

Central to her rebirth was the practical skill of tailoring. The project's training equipped Azima with more than just a vocation; it gave her a tangible purpose and a path forward. With renewed determination, she began to save diligently, setting her sights on a powerful symbol of independence: her own sewing machine. This goal transformed her daily efforts, turning stitches into steps toward self-reliance and dreams into a achievable plan for her future.

Today, Azima's identity is no longer bound by the title of a child bride. She is a skilled apprentice, a diligent saver, and, most importantly, a young woman actively becoming the author of her own life. Her journey from silent despair to purposeful action stands as a powerful testament to how targeted support, combined with skills and safe spaces, can unravel the threads of past trauma and weave a new narrative of resilience, dignity, and hope.



HOPE RESTORED THROUGH CARE



In Shagari Local Government Area of Sokoto State, a young breastfeeding mother faced fear and uncertainty as her twin babies repeatedly fell ill. Unaware of the underlying cause, she struggled to protect her children while watching their health decline. The situation changed when Life Helpers Initiative, through USAID supported ACE3 programming, reached her community with testing, counseling, and care services delivered with dignity and compassion.

Through community based testing, the mother learned her HIV status and was immediately linked to care and treatment. With continued support, guidance, and follow up, her health steadily improved. Her twin babies also received the care they needed, allowing them to grow stronger and healthier with time. What once felt like a hopeless situation slowly became a story of healing and renewed confidence.

Today, the family is thriving. The mother is healthy, her twins are growing well, and their home is filled with hope, strength, and renewed faith in life. This story reflects the power of timely intervention, community trust, and compassionate care in restoring dignity and saving lives.

PROMOTING INCLUSION, LEADERSHIP, AND PROTECTION

Gender equity is integrated across all Life Helpers Initiative programs. Women, men, girls, and boys are supported based on their specific needs, vulnerabilities, and capacities. Women play leadership roles within savings groups, farmer associations, and community committees, strengthening participation and accountability.

Girls benefit from education support, hygiene promotion, and protection awareness, while women access healthcare, livelihood opportunities, and financial inclusion services. Community engagement addresses gender based violence prevention, child protection, and social inclusion.

Gender responsive approaches strengthen fairness, safety, and resilience at household and community levels.



WESPEAK (MUYI MAGANA)

WeSpeak, also known as Muyi Magana, is a weekly radio program implemented by Life Helpers Initiative in Sokoto State. The program cuts across all thematic areas, health, education, livelihood, agriculture, and gender equity.

The platform provides timely information, encourages dialogue, and creates space for questions, feedback, and external complaints. Community members share concerns, receive referrals, and learn about available services. Civil society organizations are also invited to use the platform to raise awareness about their work and promote collaboration.

The radio program has touched the lives of many people across Sokoto State by increasing awareness, promoting positive behavior change, and strengthening accountability.



SUPPORTING ECONOMIC STABILITY AND SELF RELIANCE

Livelihood interventions support households to restore income and strengthen economic resilience. Through Village Savings and Loan Associations, women and men save regularly, access small loans, and invest in income generating activities such as petty trading, agro processing, and service provision.

Cash Based Transfers and Cash for Work initiatives provide short term financial relief while

contributing to community development activities including sanitation and environmental improvement. These interventions help households meet basic needs, reduce negative coping strategies, and rebuild dignity.

Livelihood programming is shaped by insights from community engagement and market dynamics, ensuring that support remains relevant, practical, and sustainable.

OUR MISSION

Be a leading non-governmental organisation working to maximise all opportunities to empower the marginalized people.

OUR VISION

A more Fulfilled Life for Everyone



LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

SCAN ME!

